Before You Program

BMW & VW/Audi checklist | German Car Support

1 Battery & power support

- ☐ Connect a dedicated programming power supply, not a trickle charger or jump pack. Use 70 A or more for long BMW sessions.
- ☐ Test the battery first. A weak battery can still pull voltage down under load, even with the supply on.
- ☐ Hold steady voltage for the whole session, typically 13.5-14.5 V. Never let it fall below 12.5 V. Note the reading at the start.
- ☐ Turn off loads: lights, blower, seat heat, infotainment. Close the doors (or latch them), have the key in the car and set the hood per procedure.

2 Tools, software & connection

- ☐ Software current: ISTA data level (BMW) or ODIS Service with current flash data (VW/Audi). Confirm logins, licences and online access work before you start.
- ☐ Use a supported interface (ICOM / VAS 6154-class) on a wired connection. Avoid Wi-Fi for flashing if you can.
- ☐ Laptop on AC power, with sleep, screen lock, Windows Update and antivirus scans turned off. Leave plenty of free disk space and stable internet.

3 Pre-flash prep

- ☐ Run a full scan and save the fault memory, plus vehicle order/SVT (BMW) or the full diagnostic log (VW/Audi), before touching anything.
- ☐ Fix communication, network and low-voltage faults first. Do not flash a car with known bus problems.
- ☐ Confirm the exact measure you are doing: target I-level, campaign or TSB, and the module and part numbers involved.
- ☐ Plan for the full time. Do not start a flash at the end of the day or with the customer waiting at the counter.

4 If a flash fails

- ☐ STOP. Do not unplug the interface, switch the ignition off or close the software.
- ☐ Keep the power supply on and check the voltage. Record the error message, module and step (take screenshots).
- ☐ Only retry the way the software tells you (resume/retry). Repeated blind attempts can make recovery harder.
- ☐ If the module no longer communicates, call before trying again.

Flash failed? GCS failed-programming recovery: $175 per attempt

Remote recovery for BMW and VW/Audi modules that failed during programming. Charged per attempt, whether or not the recovery succeeds. Have the vehicle on a power supply, your interface connected and your error details ready when you call.

BMW & VW/Audi remote support memberships: Gold $99/mo | Platinum $129/mo

Request access: https://gcs.collabtic.com/signup